

T. NAGAR

Saidapet » West Mambalam » Vadapalani » Porur » Kattupakkam » Irungattukottai » Nungambakkam » Manapakkam » Ashok Nagar » Valasaravakkam
Gerugambakkam » Mangadu » Choolaimedu » Egmore » K K Nagar » Kodambakkam » Virugambakkam » Somangalam » Poonamallee » Chetpet



THE CLICKETY CLACK CONTINUES

Here are voices from the city that assert that though typewriting institutes have steadily dwindled in numbers, the manual typewriter still deserves a place alongside the computer **P4**



SCREEN TIME OFF FOR SENIORS TOO

In Chennai on August 15, two workshops seek to wean grown-ups off screens by teaching them a craft **P6**

‘Vadapalani bus stop needs a shelter’



S.N. RAJARAM

It is three weeks since Metropolitan Transport Corporation restored the original route of its bus services – 26 (Royapuram-Iyyappanthangal); 37G (Vallalar Nagar- Poonamallee); and 25G (Anna Square - Poonamallee) – on the Vadapalani section of Arcot Road.

The diversion was meant for the trip towards Iyyappanthangal

and Poonamallee.

For the past six years, the Vadapalani section of Arcot Road was made one-way to facilitate metro rail construction (corridor four under phase two).

As the work is almost complete now, MTC has restored the original route of buses on this section of Arcot Road. This is an immense relief to the commuters. But confusion and disorder prevails.

In the case of stop at Vadapalani



Vadapalani terminus bus stop; and (right) Forum mall bus stop.

bus terminus, some buses stop near metro rail pillar number 51 and some near 54. Commuters have to run and board the buses.

Once the stormwater drain work which is under way gets completed, bus shelters should be in-

stalled. However, a signboard is necessary on a temporary basis.

Likewise, there is a bus shelter near metro rail pillar number 38. It is called Forum Mall stop due to its proximity to the Forum Vijaya Mall. Here, some buses halt and

some do not. The bus shelter is misused to park vehicles.

I request Metropolitan Transport Corporation to look into these issues.

S.N. Rajaram is a resident of Saligramam

Better traffic regulation sought at Little Mount-Saidapet junction

T.S. ATUL SWAMINATHAN

The pedestrian crossing signal at Little Mount on Anna Salai also serves as a vehicular signal.

While pedestrians cross, a good distance ahead of them, motorists from Velachery Road can enter Anna Salai towards Nandanam. But motorists from Guindy jump the signal, posing a risk to their motorists from Velachery.

T. Sivanandham, a motorist, says, “The motorists halt the traffic and cause congestion on Anna Salai towards Guindy. Collisions are always a possibility. The Greater Chennai Traffic



The Little Mount junction on Anna Salai.

Poice should deploy its personnel to regulate the Little Mount junction.”

“On the lane along Saidapet bridge,” S. Shivakumar, a motorist, says, “the same pattern is followed. Motorists honk, signalling to those coming from Velachery to halt, only in vain

and are forced to apply brakes at the last minute. Accidents are a miss and waiting to happen.”

Motorists from Velachery Road drive at a fast clip despite the flow of traffic from Guindy. The risk is higher as the lane is wide.

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▼
The flyover at Peters Road -
Conran Smith Road junction.
PHOTO: RAGU R



Focus on *‘underbellies’* of flyovers

The flyover at Mahalingapuram and the ones on Pantheon Road and North Usman Road are part of this project

R. RAGU

What verandahs are to sprawling bungalows, spaces-under-flyovers are to major roads. They catch the eye more than anything else, and help form an opinion of the rest of the house as well as the

road. The spaces under flyovers in Chennai have often fared poorly, showcasing squalor more than beauty despite so-called beautification efforts. From time to time, residents have been witness to vertical gardens wilting and then progressively going from bad to worse, the containers going

empty with the plants in them doing a Houdini-like disappearing act. Against this backdrop, it is heartening to note that Greater Chennai Corporation is taking a fresh look at these prominent spaces. GCC's Special Projects Wing is set to revamp the underbellies of 10 flyovers into usable public spaces with

parks, walking tracks and parking lots with EV charging facilities.

A peek into the list

The space under the Peters Road - Conran Smith Road flyover gives an inkling of what is to come. According to someone associated with Greater Chennai

Corporation and familiar with the development, the other flyovers that come under this new project include the flyover near Music Academy, the flyover near Narada Gana Sabha, the flyover in Mahalingapuram, the flyover near Government Museum in Egmore and the new flyover on North Usman Road.

New entrance gateway at MCC school in Chetpet

A new entrance gateway has been constructed at Madras Christian College Higher Secondary School in Chetpet through the generous contributions of the alumni who studied at the school in 1975.

The gateway featuring an elegant clock tower and the school's name plaque, was formally inaugurated on August 1, 2026.

The newly constructed gateway was dedicated by K. M. Mammen, chairman of the M.C.C. Association, in the presence of alumni, members of the school management, staff, and invited guests, says a press release.

The new entrance gateway stands as a lasting symbol of the enduring bond between the school and its alumni, reflecting their gratitude and commitment to the continued growth and development of their alma mater, the release adds.



▼
During the inaugural event on August 1. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Key road in Iyyappanthangal is battered

Residents' forum notes water supply work on Agraharam Main Road is moving at a tardy pace

Regular users find driving on Agraharam Main Road in Iyyappanthangal Village Panchayat quite trying on laying water pipes by the Chennai Metropolitan Water Supply & Sewerage Board (CMWSSB) is under way.

Confederation of Iyyappanthangal Residents Welfare Associations, a citizens forum, wants CMWSSB to complete the work at the earliest.

The citizens' forum is of the view that the work is progressing at a snail's pace as it notices no sign of work or activity on the road for the past few months.

"The work began this January and had to be put on hold when the code of conduct for elections came into effect this March. But the work did not resume even after the elections. Agraharam Main Road is narrow and provides connectivity to Mount-Poonamallee High Road and therefore witness-

es good traffic during peak hours. As it is in a bad shape, driving on this road is quite difficult. Further, the battered state promotes waterlogging. The authorities should consider restoring the road on sections where the pipe-laying work got completed," says P. Senthil Kumar, the forum's coordinator.

The confederation also highlights the possibility of mosquito breeding in the sump which is being constructed as part of this water supply project at EVP Park Avenue.

"A big trench has been created for sump construction. Here again, there is no sign of work. This part of the work should be completed at the earliest and the trench should be closed. Otherwise, the open trench will provide a conducive environment for mosquito breeding," adds Senthil.

CMWSSB officials did not respond to the calls.



Agraharam Main Road in Iyyappanthangal.
PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

READERS WRITE

'Park redevelopment work moves at a snail's pace'



The park at Peeran Street in Vadapalani.

ARJUN BHASKAR

The redevelopment work at the Greater Chennai Corporation's park at Peeran Street in Vadapalani began a few months ago. The park wears a new look with a fresh coat of paint and art works. This suggests that a good part of the work is complete. However, play equipment have not been installed.

All these years, the recreational space was in a state of neglect and it was misused by tipplers to consume alcohol. Therefore, the facility failed to draw visitors.



It is good that Greater Chennai Corporation has spruced up the park but the needful should be done to reopen it at the earliest.

Arjun Bhaskar is a resident of Vadapalani



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Dear readers, you can be our volunteer-writer by writing to us about issues and events in your neighbourhood. You should send the write-ups to downtownfeedback@thehindu.co.in. Letters must carry the contact number.

'Key junction needs mending work'



The junction of Bazullah Road and Raghavaiah Road in T. Nagar.
PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

GANESAN GANAPATHI

The junction of Bazullah Road and Raghavaiah Road in T. Nagar is battered and gives room for waterlogging. Also, traffic movement slows down here. This junction witnesses heavy traffic; therefore the road should be well maintained.

Ganesan Ganapathi is a resident of T. Nagar.

Cables pose a risk here



The image, taken on August 4, 2026, shows telecommunication cables lying on the Vadapalani stretch of Arcot Road. Pedestrians can trip over them and fall. Greater Chennai Corporation introduced a drive in September 2022 to clear unused cables. However, the problem continues to this day.

The clickety clack continues



LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

A chorus of clickety-clacks from manual typewriters drowns the bustle on Jagannathapuram First Street, which sits in a tract of Chetpet where every house leans into the next somewhat like books in a library shelf. Inside, as young fingers dance over ageing manual typewriters, kept sprightly by consistent maintenance, teacher-plus-owner of Chetpet Typewriting Institute (est. 1975) P. Padmanabhan is supervising yet another class, spelling out instructions to students.

Typing proficiency opening doors to certain clerical positions in government and private settings, being an essential component in certain competitive government exams including TNPSC Group IV, certain categories of Staff Selection Commission, institutes of this nature still thrive. Padmanabhan points out every class includes students who see typing skill as an end in itself. Therefore, also expect those training for careers in law, the corporate world and so on to walk in through those doors.

And these multiple needs keep these instruments going, refur-



P. Padmanabhan at Chetpet Typewriting Institute; and (below) typewriter mechanic S. Thyagarajan.

2006, taking the mantle from his father and running Chetpet Typewriting Institute. The institute operating from a space in Padmanabhan's house, makes the overheads of running it manageable. He notes with quiet pride, "I am a certified high-speed typewriting expert and an official government examiner," recognised by the Ta-

mil Nadu Directorate of Technical Education (DoTE). With 50 students at present, Padmanabhan personally teaches both Tamil and English typewriting; shorthand classes are also offered. His voice resonating with justifiable pride, he says: "Search my name online, you will find it."

Certainly, decades ago, every street probably sported a typewriting institute. Those like Padmanabhan maintain their numbers would have dwindled, but their relevance has not been eroded. And this is why, 20 years after retirement, he continues to fill his house with a chorus of clickety-clacks.

'Rescuing' typewriters

The phone rings, and within minutes, 54-year-old S. Thyagarajan is on his way to 'rescue' another manual typewriter. There is no workshop, no colourful signboards announcing his trade. He is the workshop on the move; and his experience repairing manual

typewriters since 1986 is the signboard. Owners of typewriting institutes across Chennai have his number saved as "ICE". That is obviously hyperbole, but typewriter mechanics such as Thyagarajan are indeed indispensable in "emergency" situations involving these machines, as brands selling manual typewriters have long ceased production, and the old machines have to be kept in circulation. Thyagarajan entered the profession soon after completing Class 10, having been born into a family of typewriter mechanics, his grandfather and uncle particularly known in the trade. The clatter of these machines defines his earliest memories, and he is among a dedicated group of people who refuse to let manual typewriters become a memory. While typewriter manufacturers have ceased production, he says typewriters are far from extinction. "The spare parts still come from Delhi. A manufacturer who started the business when typewriters were in their heyday continues to supply them to this day," he explains.

He notes that around 40 regular customers, including several typewriting institutes still rely on his services. Thyagarajan once ran repair shops which he shut down as rents escalated. "Every occupation evolves with time. One phone is enough now to run your business," he says.

He is a staunch believer not only in these machines, but also what they bring to the table, well sheet. He is emphatic those trained on typewriters make fewer mistakes because their fingers develop greater typing accuracy than those who learn typing directly on computer keyboards, particularly while typing Indian languages such as Tamil. "Even my name has been misspelt umpteen number of times," he remarks bitterly, adding that such mistakes can create unnecessary complications in government records. And for that reason and also for the fact that livelihoods still depend on typewriting institutes, he wants these old machines to continue clicking away in classrooms and examination halls.

bished from time to time. Chetpet Typewriting Institute is not the oldest, but is symbolic of typewriting institutes continuing despite challenges from technology.

Padmanabhan belabours typewriting institutes' continuing relevance, citing numbers and benefits. "There are 4,200 government-approved typewriting institutes across Tamil Nadu," he states. "Typewriting equips a person to type faster and more efficiently. Once you master it, operating a computer becomes effortless."

This belief has had Padmanabhan, now aged 75, wearing a new hat post his retirement as medical photo officer (also known as 'medical photographer') from Rajiv Gandhi Government Hospital in

A plea to the Tamil Nadu government

Typewriting institutes are anxious over a government order dated October 28, 2024 stating that the Department of Technical Education (DoTE) in Tamil Nadu would be doing away with the practice of having typing exams on manual typewriters, shifting them to computers from February 2028. Echoing the collective sentiment of associations representing typewriting institutes across the state, J. Srinivasan of Karumari Technical Institute in Saidapet, told The Hindu Downtown that typewriting exams in English and Tamil should be conducted only on typewriters. He points out, "Besides, the Computer on Office Automation (COA) exam should not be merged with the English and Tamil typewriting exams. Instead, the current system of conducting the three exams separately with a separate certificate given for each should continue. Every year, more than one lakh students take typing exams, conducted every six months. Clubbing them with COA will reduce the number of takers; and that will result in reduced revenue for the government." Srinivasan adds that switching typing exams from manual typewriters to computers will affect the livelihoods of typewriting institutes and typewriter mechanics across Tamil Nadu, which he estimates around 5000 and 2000 respectively. He states: "Associations and federations representing these institutes and mechanics want this GO cancelled."

A Fight For Survival
In the run-up to Madras Day, a look at an old industry that is pitted against new technology

Here are voices from the city that assert that though typewriting institutes have steadily dwindled in numbers since Madras became Chennai, the manual typewriter still deserves a place under the sun, alongside the computer



ERR

In focus: Elevator Safety 101

If the lift in your apartment gets stuck often, it is time to check when its license was last renewed

LIFFY THOMAS

In the last one year, how many times have you or a family member got stranded in a lift in your residential building?

Of the 1,540 responses from Chennai residents that LocalCircles received to this question, 48% said they were fortunate not to get stuck; 25% were unfortunate to have that unsavoury experience once or twice.

Just like elevators in public spaces and mass transit facilities such as MRTS stations, those at apartment communities can show their malfunctioning machine side, frustrating residents. When an elevator malfunctions in any setting, private or public, and causes a safety threat to users, who are the entities one pins the blame on?

Going by a recent Supreme Court ruling, the ma-

nufacturer, the maintenance agency and the owner of the premises are jointly liable for any breach of the safety of lift users.

A pan-India study by community social media platform LocalCircles found 33% had no confidence in the safety of lifts installed in their building. Close to 32% of the respondents from Chennai said the lift in their community was maintained by the lift manufacturer via annual maintenance contract (AMC); another 37% said lifts were maintained by a third party via AMC; 20% said no regular maintenance, only repairs based on issues.

Although the Tamil Nadu Lift Rules

Act, 1997 got amended this year, accountability is still raised only after a lift malfunctions or an accident happens. Many lifts continue to function without license renewal.

Challenges to inspection

In fact, identifying lifts functioning without a valid licence is a big challenge faced by the Electrical Inspectorate, a department under the Government of Tamil Nadu. Besides other functions, the department is responsible for issuing of permission for lifts and escalators to be installed and for the renewal of licenses.

As per the Tamil Nadu Lifts and Escalators (Amendment) Act, 2025, which came into effect in February 2026, license for lifts has to be renewed once in five years.

V. Ramakrishnan, chief electrical inspector to the State Government, says they previously used to send reminders to buildings for renewal, but now that the process is "auto generated" they stopped.

Renewal process

can be done online and must be initiated three months before it expires. The average fee for renewal and penalty for late payment is a small sum, a reason why many buildings ignore it.

The renewal process is important to identify defects and take up preventive steps before a compliance report is submitted

"It is not possible to keep inspecting buildings that have not renewed their licence as there are hundreds of buildings with this facility, but based on complaints we do random checks," says Ramakrishnan, adding that the public can bring it to the department's notice.

Recently, when passengers were trapped in a lift at Puzhuthivakkam MRTS station, the department sent out its team to inspect it.

Besides shortage in manpower, the Department is often faced with issues among residents in apartment associations who derail the process for renewal.

The official says that very recently at an apartment in Chennai the secretary of the association had applied for renewal but the president called to complain that the exercise was taken up without approval of a majority of residents.

"In apartments, there is conflict among residents as those on the ground floor do not want to pay for lift charges and renewal, so we are asked to intervene," he says.

For complaints and other issues, email ceig@tn.gov.in and ceig@tn.nic.in

Paying a premium to ensure safe lifts

This gated community in Manapakkam allocates a huge sum every year for the maintenance of its elevators

Casagrand Irene, a gated community in Manapakkam with 295 flats spread across 15 blocks and 13 villas, has ensured lift-related complaints are kept to a minimum by paying a premium for the maintenance of lifts.

"We spend 4-5 percent of our total revenue in lift maintenance, which translates to around ₹ 10.5 lakh annually," says Lebbaeus Denis, secretary, Casagrand Irene Owners Welfare Association.

Under a contract with Schneider Electricals, the Association has signed up for Diamond Category Annual Maintenance Contract (AMC), which is the highest in the plan, gold and silver being the other two categories.

In the diamond category, all spare parts including battery

come under unlimited warranty. Every year, the company also undertakes a pre-maintenance schedule in which they replace most of the parts in the functioning of the lift. Besides, what is mandated by the manufacturer, once in every two years the Association replaces the batteries as well, especially in blocks where lifts see more wear and tear.

"There are two batteries in one lift, each costing ₹13,000. The life a battery lasts three years but as a precautionary measure we schedule the replacement a little before the cut-off time," says Denis.

Besides checks every month, the community just needs to raise a complaint in a software and in three hours the technical team arrives to fix the issue.

As in many communities where owners of flats on the ground floor complain about paying for an amenity they rarely use, this community has faced this situation. With villas also dotting the community, they have a big voice against spiralling bills on lift maintenance.

Denis feels that expenditure will keep coming but Associations need to find alternative revenue streams. "We have allotted space for digital ads kept outside the lift that give us ₹ 6 lakh revenue a year, this way we are incurring a more manageable expense on lift maintenance and at the same time ensuring residents have little to complain about," says the secretary.





SHARON JESSICA MICHAEL

When conversations around screen addiction come up, they almost always centre on children and teenagers. But what about the adults who spend their workdays peering into laptops, unwind by scrolling through social media, and end the day glued to the television screen?

Here is the outline of an answer to that. And it is being sketched by The Kraft Faktor, a small-batch handmade products brand, creating soaps, shampoos, perfumes, candles and home fragrances, that has over time tucked an experience-based initiative into the shopping bag, conducting craft-based workshops, curating personalised gifts and developing DIY kits for people to continue crafting at home.

Deepa Sam and Nabeela Rehman, founders of The Kraft Faktor (TKF), view digital overload as cutting across demographic divides. TKF has inked in a couple of small-batch workshops (Mindful Line Art & Pattern Making and Paper Alchemy - Beginner-friendly Decoupage) for August 15 (11 a.m. to 1 p.m.) at Playbae Cafe in Thoraipakkam that indirectly address screen addiction. For participation, the number of birthdays someone has had so far carries little weight. For additional details about the workshop, DM them on Insta @thekraftfaktor.

These workshops have a philosophical underpinning, simple but far-reaching.

"We are saying: consciously build a habit in your 20s and 30s of practising some form of art or craft every day," says Deepa. "It could be anything. It could simply be cooking a meal or consciously grooming yourself. If these small routines are done consciously, the results are not visible in one or two days, but over time they make a difference."

Participants of TKF's workshops range from young professionals looking for a break from busy work schedules to retirees trying to fill the void that often follows decades of routine. "We noticed that this stage of life often leaves a huge vacuum," says Deepa. "Many people naturally fall into digital consumption."

For the founders, the concern is not simply the amount of time

Screen addiction is disproportionately associated with children and teenagers, adults often being a glaring omission. In Chennai on August 15, two workshops seek to wean grown-ups off screens by teaching them a craft

Screen time off for seniors too



people spend online. It is the way screens constantly compete for attention. "For me, it is very simply put – overstimulation versus correct stimulation," Deepa says. "On a screen there are hundreds of images and notifications. Even if you are only watching a few posts or one reel, you generally do not stop because social media is designed to keep you hooked."

Here is the contrast TKF seeks to drive home through its workshops.

"When you are creating a craft with your hands, your brain focuses on one task for 15-20 minutes. You are following one process, one sequence, one goal. There is also a natural stopping point. You finish one page, one piece or one step," Deepa adds.

Unlike scrolling through an endless stream of content, craft requires people to interact with real materials, making decisions, changing tack and reviewing the output. Paper has to be folded. Wax has to be poured. Glue has to be applied. Hands move objects, feel textures and respond to the material in front of them. Instead of reacting to rapidly changing colours, movement and notifications, attention stays with one activity at a time.

Nabeela elaborates: "With doomscrolling, you are only taking in information. Every second you are absorbing something new. When you are doing an activity, you are constantly asking yourself, 'What next? How can I do this? Is there a better way than last time?' There's a give-and-take in the process."

Mindfulness is a healthy by-product. Someone who makes things regularly is also more likely to think carefully about what they buy, how they use materials and whether something can be repaired, reused or repurposed instead of discarded.

The workshops themselves are intentionally small, with no more than eight participants at a time. A DIY kit is part of what every workshop offers, making it easier for participants to keep practising long after the session ends.



From a line art workshop; and the result of a decoupage exercise.

One year certificate course on entrepreneurship

Entrepreneurship Development & Innovation Institute - Chennai along with Entrepreneurship Development & Innovation Institute - Ahmedabad is offering a one-year certificate course on Entrepreneurship & Innovation. Classes for this will start this month. Graduates aged between 21 and 40 years can apply. Applications can be downloaded from the following link: <https://editn.in/Web-One-Year-Registration>

E-Commerce workshop

Entrepreneurship Development & Innovation Institute - Chennai is conducting a workshop on E-Commerce from August 19 to 21.

According to a press release, the session will focus on different types of direct-to-consumer business model; selection of appropriate e-commerce platforms based on busi-

ness goals; creation of effective product listings and pricing strategies. Participants will also learn about marketing, customer acquisition, retention strategies, and branding.

Creation of YouTube channel

Another workshop on creation of YouTube channel will be held from August 12 to 14.



The programme will introduce participants to the effective use of artificial intelligence and digital tools for content creation, channel optimization, and monetization. The session will also focus on fundamentals of YouTube Analytics

to understand channel performance.

Training in gold appraisal

The institute is also conducting another workshop on gold appraisal from August 17 to 21.

Participants will learn about the differences between karat and carat; methods of calculating gold and silver purity; and loan assessment procedures for gold and silver.

All the three workshops will be held from 10 a.m. to 5 p.m. at the centre's premises at EDII Road, SIDCO Industrial Estate, Guindy.

For details, call 8668100181 / 9360221280

51st sports day at Crescent School



The 51st sports day of Crescent Matriculation Higher Secondary School for Girls was held with great enthusiasm and camaraderie at the University Union Grounds in Chetpet recently.

A spectacular display of ceremonial opening march past by the school houses showcased discipline, precision, and teamwork.

The sports torch was lit and carried in a solemn torch relay, stated a release issued by the institution.

V. Vanitha, IPS, declared the meet open

and inspired the gathering with an address that highlighted the importance of discipline, perseverance, and physical fitness in shaping responsible citizens.

She appreciated the students' participation and encouraged them to pursue excellence both on the field and in life.

Bushra Amanullah, principal, presented the annual sports report, highlighting the outstanding achievements of students in various inter-school and state-level sporting events and acknowledged the relentless dedication of the school's physical education department.

Training in making ready-to-cook food products

Tamil Nadu Agricultural University Information & Training Centre is conducting a workshop on ready-to-cook millet food products on August 13. Concepts of marketing will also be covered. Another workshop on vermicomposting will be held on August 14. Both the sessions will be held at the centre's premises at Agro Tech Green Park, First Floor, Thiru. Vi. Ka. Industrial Estate, Guindy. For details, call 044 - 29530048



Alumni meet at Guindy college



The 1961-1966 batch of College of Engineering, Guindy, celebrated their diamond jubilee at the Alumni Association Hall of the college.

Popularly called "Guindineers 66" or G66, the alumni gathered to celebrate their six decades of friendship.

The event was marked by a quiz, a Zoom connect with G66 alumni in the USA. An e-booklet of memories and anecdotes was released to mark the occasion. An interactive session on preventive health care for senior citizens was also part of the programme, adds the release.

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Pinkathon spotlights preventive healthcare for women in Chennai

The Zydus Pinkathon was held at the Island Grounds in Chennai on Sunday to promote women's health, fitness and preventive healthcare.

As per a press release, the event featured race categories ranging from 3 km, 5 km and 10 km to ultra-distance events of 50 km, 75 km and 100 km. Over 3,000 women were said to have participated in the event, including first-time runners, cancer survivors, visually impaired runners, babywearing mothers and senior citizens.

A hair donation drive was organised as part of the event, where several partici-



pants donated their hair to be used for making wigs for cancer patients. The event also highlighted breast cancer awareness through Zydus Lifesciences' "The Easiest Exam" campaign, which encourages women to perform regular self-breast examina-

tions for early detection.

Pinkathon founder Milind Soman said the initiative aims to create an inclusive platform that encourages women from all walks of life to adopt healthier lifestyles and prioritise preventive healthcare.

Aadi Vizha at Bhavan's

Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan is conducting Aadi Vizha from August 10 to 14 at its main auditorium in Mylapore. The series includes Harikatha, musical discourses, Villupaattu and Bakthi Padalgal. The programmes scheduled include discourse by Nagai Mukundan on Kandhan Karunai on August 10, 6.30 p.m.; Villupaattu by Bharathi Thirumagan on Aadi Katril Amman Ula on August 11, 6.30 pm; Musical Discourse by Suchitra on Entha Ruchira Rama on August 12, 6.30 pm; Namasankirthanam by Udayalur Kalyanaraman on August 13, 6.30 pm; and Bakthi Padalgal by Veeramani Raju on August 14, 6.30 pm. All events are open to all.

Nominate a teacher that made a difference

Mission Guru Devo Bhava, in association with the Lions Club of Meenambakkam, invites nominations for the third edition of Vidhya Seva Samman.

The initiative aims to honour teachers who have gone beyond the classroom, inspired their students, nurtured values and made a genuine difference to their lives.

Anil Kitcha, in a press note, says the initiative hopes to build a tradition through which society respectfully thanks teachers and whose



influence extends far beyond the classroom and transformed the lives of their students and strengthened communities.

This year, the organisers propose to honour 10 deserving teachers from schools across Chennai. Each awardee will receive a cash award of ₹50,000, a citation and a memento.

Schools, parents, students, teachers and members of the public can nominate a teacher that truly deserves a recognition.

The late date to nominate in August 15, 2026. The awards will be presented on September 6, 2026 at the DAV Girls Senior Secondary School auditorium, Gopalapuram.

For details, visit tinyurl.com/vssteachernomination

RMKV's new collection inspired by Japanese culture

RMKV Silks, known for its wedding silks and silk saris, has launched a range of exclusive handwoven silks inspired by Japanese heritage and culture, 'Kumo Korvai', 'Mt Fuji', and 'Sashiko Reversible'.

The silks, known for their pioneering designs and advanced weaving techniques, have earned the brand two national awards, a Guinness World Record, and several patents, according to a release from the enterprise.

The store has partnered with the Central Silk Board to develop a modernised pneumatic handloom, an innovation designed to reduce the physical strain of weaving while enabling artisans to better use their skills and enhance productivity. By making the weaving process less labour-intensive, the initiative has also encouraged greater participation of women in the craft, creating new opportunities while preserving the essence of traditional handloom weaving, the release added.

The store is renowned for its naturally dyed silk saris and patented 40 percent lighter 'Lino' silk saris, the grand reversible sari, and the world's longest theme-silk sari, the release said.

Bring your old zari sari to Rasi Silks

Rasi Silks (Radha Silk Emporium), which was established in 1900, offers a comprehensive shopping experience for the entire family. Its portal <https://rasisilks.com> displays a magnificent collection from signature Kancheepuram pure silk saris to lightweight cottons, Pochampally and Banaras weaves, said a release.

The portal also features a

dedicated, premium segment of ethnic wear for men, designed for weddings, festivals and formal gatherings. The classic men's kurta is meticulously tailored from pure silk and fine cotton, featuring both subtle, minimalist designs and intricate traditional motifs.

The portal is secure for online payments, added the release.

The Mylapore-based outlet is having an old sari exchange initiative. Customers can bring in their heirloom, old pure zari saris for evaluation, and upgrade their wardrobes with stunning new drapes.



Essay competition on eye donation

In observance of National Eye Donation Fortnight, TwinTech Healthcare Services, a unit of the TwinTech Institute of Education Trust is conducting an essay competition on the theme "Donate Eyes, Gift Sight, and Give Life."

The competition is open to all.

The essay can be in English or Tamil not exceeding 1,500 words, highlighting the importance of eye donation, its impact on individuals and society, and innovative ways to motivate people to pledge their eyes.

Details about the participant such as full name, age, complete postal address, along with a brief profile should be mentioned.

Participants are expected to sub-

mit original essays and AI-generated entries will be disqualified without any notice, says a press release.

The initiative aims to spread awareness about the importance of eye donation and encourage people to pledge their eyes as that would help restore sight to individuals affected by corneal blindness, through the priceless gift of eye donation.

The last date for submission of the essay is August 15 by 5 p.m. to the following email: chennai.twintech@gmail.com

The winners will be announced on August 20.

For details, participants may contact Dr. A. Mahalingam through WhatsApp: 97104 85295.

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